

# Games & Fun Pack • Jokes, Riddles and Brain Teasers

## Games and Fun

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The Hackles crew, drawn from life: Hackle (1) and the six friends who look after each strand.

**Hackles • a free kit • [quillsup.org](https://quillsup.org)**

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[Logo: Hackles]

### 30 JOKES, RIDDLES AND BRAIN TEASERS

*Kid-clean, security-themed, and funny on purpose*

**Trust your hackles.** *Pause · Check · Tell*

Hackles · a free kit · [quillsup.org](https://quillsup.org)

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**No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.**

## Teacher Quick Start (one page, print and keep)

**What it is:** 30 short jokes, riddles and teasers, each hiding one real skill.

Use them as warm-ups, exit tickets, transition fillers or a "Joke of the Day". Each takes 1 to 2 minutes.

| IF YOU HAVE...               | USE                                                                                                   | TIME   |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| A 1-minute warm-up           | Read 1 joke (K-2: J1-J8; 3-5: J9-J16; 6-12: J17-J23). Wait for the groan. Ask "What is the real tip?" | 1 min  |
| A 3-minute transition        | A brain teaser (J24-J30), solved in pairs; the answer key is at the bottom.                           | 3 min  |
| A 10-minute station          | The "Riddle Café": students order a riddle from a menu, solve it, add one joke to the Joke Jar.       | 10 min |
| An end-of-lesson exit ticket | "Tell me the skill in this joke" on the way out (J2, J8, J12, J19).                                   | 1 min  |

**How to deliver:** read the joke in a voice (Gifty talks like a game-show host with a cold, Peeper goes "Hmmmmmm", Latch whispers). Pause. Say the answer. **Groan loudly: a groan is a win.** Then ask the "real skill" question.

**If...**

- **A joke does not land (ELL or young children miss a pun):** explain the pun in one sentence, laugh with them, move on. Puns are the hardest part of a new language; use the picture-riddle and teaser versions for newcomers.
- **A child tells a joke that is about a person who got tricked or hurt:** "We laugh at the trick, not the person. Try it again about Gifty." (Rules of Funny, Rule 1.)
- **A child's joke is about fear, injury or real events:** thank them privately and offer another idea. Do not read it aloud.

**Never:** make a child the butt of a joke, tell jokes about real incidents, or use real names in a joke.

# How to use this section

Laughter lowers shields. A child who is laughing is a child who is not afraid, and a child who is not afraid is a child who can learn the skill. These 30 pieces are short enough to use as **warm-ups, exit tickets, transition fillers, bulletin-board "Joke of the Day," or sub-plan fillers.** Each one hides a real idea (a password rule, a scam clue, a reason to tell).

## The rules of funny (keep them):

- 1. **Laugh with, never at.** No joke is ever about a *person* who was tricked, or a *kind* of person. The butt of every joke is the **trick**, the **Too-Good Box**, the **pop-up**, or the **bad password**.
- 2. **Never about real harm.** No jokes about fear, injury, threats, or anything a child might have experienced.
- 3. **Everyone can groan.** A groan is a win. Teachers: groan loudly.
- 4. **Tell it in a voice.** Gifty speaks like a game-show host with a cold. Peeper goes "Hmmmmmm!" Latch whispers.
- 5. **Let kids tell jokes back.** Offer a "Joke Jar" box; students may write a joke (it must pass the Rules of Funny). The teacher reads a few each Friday.
- 6. **Every answer is a skill.** After the laugh, ask: "What is the real tip in that joke?" (The "Skill" column has it.)

## QUICK INDEX

| RANGE      | WHAT                                               | COUNT |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------|
| J1 to J8   | K-2 jokes (read aloud)                             | 8     |
| J9 to J16  | 3-5 jokes and riddles                              | 8     |
| J17 to J23 | 6-12 dry-humor one-liners                          | 7     |
| J24 to J30 | Brain teasers for all bands (puzzles with answers) | 7     |

## K-2 Jokes (J1 to J8)

(Read aloud. Use hand signals and silly voices. Children can echo the answers.)

| #  | JOKE                                                            | ANSWER                                                                   | THE REAL SKILL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| J1 | Why wouldn't the padlock tell the parrot its password?          | Because parrots <b>repeat everything!</b>                                | Passwords are only for you and a trusted grown-up (Latch). <i>(The first draft said the padlock was invited to parties because it "keeps a secret", which could teach that keeping secrets is always good. The Hackles message is: keep your password secret, but never keep a worrying secret from a trusted grown-up.)</i> |
| J2 | What did Hackle say to the pop-up that offered a free pony?     | <b>"Neigh, thanks!"</b>                                                  | Pause and say no to "too good to be true".                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| J3 | Knock, knock. Who's there? <b>Ima</b> . Ima who?                | <b>Ima not telling you my password! Nice try!</b>                        | Don't share passwords.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| J4 | What did the banana say when a stranger asked for its password? | <b>"Nope! I'm peeling out of here!"</b>                                  | Don't give passwords to strangers.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| J5 | Why is Pip so good at keeping private things private?           | Pip is very <b>shell-ective!</b> (Selective: Pip chooses what to share.) | Private info stays private.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| J6 | What did Fixit say after making an oops?                        | <b>"Oops! I tightened the wrong bolt! Good thing I told Buddy!"</b>      | Oopses are fixable; tell a grown-up.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| J7 | How does Peeper find clues?                                     | With a very big magnifying glass and a lot of <b>"Hmmmmmm."</b>          | Check before you click.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| J8 | Why did nobody want Gifty's gift?                               | It came with a <b>catch...</b> and a hook!                               | If it seems too good to be true, there's a catch.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

**Teacher moves:** Ask the class to **freeze** after J2 and show the Pause Palm. After J6, do the Tell Wave. After J8, ask, "What is Gifty's hook?"

**Extension:** Children draw the joke (a banana running away).

## 3-5 Jokes and Riddles (J9 to J16)

| #   | JOKE OR RIDDLE                                                                                               | ANSWER                                                                                 | THE REAL SKILL                                                                                                                                              |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| J9  | What is the best kind of password?                                                                           | One that <b>nobody can guess, not even the dog.</b>                                    | Make it unguessable (not a name or birthday).                                                                                                               |
| J10 | Why did the passphrase win the hide-and-seek championship?                                                   | It was <b>long</b> , it was <b>silly</b> , and nobody could guess where it was hiding. | Long, silly, secret.                                                                                                                                        |
| J11 | Riddle: I am long and I am silly. I have four words, but I never say them out loud to a stranger. What am I? | <b>A passphrase.</b>                                                                   | Passphrase rules.                                                                                                                                           |
| J12 | Why does the Pause button ruin a scammer's day?                                                              | It <b>spoils the countdown.</b> ("Only 5 minutes left!")                               | Pressure is a trick. Pause.                                                                                                                                 |
| J13 | What do you call a message that says "FREE!", "HURRY!" and "Don't tell anyone"?                              | <b>SPOT-tacular!</b> You can find all four letters: S, P, O, T. (And a very big hook.) | SPOT checklist.                                                                                                                                             |
| J14 | Why did the fake website fail spelling?                                                                      | It couldn't tell a <b>I from an I</b> (pixel pals).                                    | Spot lookalike links.                                                                                                                                       |
| J15 | How is a trusted adult like a ladder?                                                                        | They <b>help you climb</b> when you're stuck.                                          | The Help Ladder.                                                                                                                                            |
| J16 | Why was Fixit such a good teacher?                                                                           | It showed everyone that a mistake is just <b>a fix waiting to happen.</b>              | Recovery; no shame. ( <i>The first draft joked about a sock in a toaster; children copy what is funny and toasters are dangerous, so it was replaced.</i> ) |

**Teacher moves:** Do a "Joke Autopsy": after the groan, ask which SPOT letter or Ladder rung is hiding in the joke. Have students write their own joke (Rules of Funny apply).

**Extension:** Pair up and tell a riddle in the "Whisper Round" so only your partner hears.

## 6-12 Dry-Humor One-Liners (J17 to J23)

(Teens prefer understatement. Deliver deadpan.)

| #   | ONE-LINER                                                                                                                  | THE REAL SKILL                                                    |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| J17 | "My password is 'incorrect.' So when I forget it, the computer tells me: 'Your password is incorrect.'"                    | Classic: and a reminder that "forgot it" is why we use a manager. |
| J18 | "Two-step verification told Password: 'It's not you, it's... okay, it is you. I need a second step in this relationship.'" | A second step is trust-but-verify.                                |
| J19 | "I got an email saying I won the lottery. I'd have been more excited if I'd bought a ticket."                              | You can't win what you didn't enter. (Amazing offer.)             |

| #   | ONE-LINER                                                                                                                          | THE REAL SKILL                                |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| J20 | "How do you tell a real message from a scam? Count the exclamation points. Real ones are usually calmer."                          | Fast, loud, pushy equals suspicious.          |
| J21 | "My password manager and I have a great relationship. It remembers everything. I remember one thing."                              | Unique passphrase per account, one memorized. |
| J22 | "I asked a website to prove I'm not a robot. Now I have to identify traffic lights. I'm starting to question who's checking whom." | Checks go both ways: verify the site, too.    |
| J23 | "'Free' is the most expensive word on the internet."                                                                               | Free offers often cost you data or attention. |

**Teacher moves:** Ask, "Which FLAGS letter is in this joke?" (J19: A, Amazing offer. J20: F, Fast. J23: A.) Ask students to write a one-liner for one of the **second channel** ideas.

**Extension:** "Dry Delivery Day": students perform their one-liners as deadpan comedians. Rules of Funny.

# Brain Teasers (J24 to J30)

(For all bands; each has a K-2/3-5/6-12 version. Answers in the second table.)

## THE TEASERS

**J24: The Secret Message (cipher).** Bands 3-8. Shift each letter **back by one** (B becomes A, C becomes B...):

|                          |       |
|--------------------------|-------|
| <i>Field note</i>        | No. 1 |
| UIF TFDSFU XPSE JT TJMMZ |       |

*Hint:* "Say the alphabet in your head. If the code says U, the letter before U is T."

**J25: Silly Orders (counting).** Bands 3-12. You have three silly word cards: **banana, rocket, trumpet**. How many different orders can you make a three-word passphrase out of them using each card once? (Example: banana-rocket-trumpet.)

*K-2 version:* Lay out three picture cards. How many different ways can you line them up? (Try it with your hands.)

**J26: Which Is Real? (spot the odd one).** Bands 3-12. The real game site is **pixelpals.example**. Which of these is the real one?

|                                                                                                                   |       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| <i>Field note</i>                                                                                                 | No. 2 |
| A) pixelpals.example<br>B) pixe1pals.example<br>C) pixelpals-free.example<br>D) pixelpals.example.win-big.example |       |

**J27: The Missing Step.** Bands K-12. The routine goes: **Hackles up. Pause.** \_\_\_\_\_. **Tell.** What is the missing word?

*K-2 version:* Show the four hand signals. Which one is missing: Hackles Up, Pause Palm, ?, Tell Wave.

**J28: Word Scrambles.** Bands 3-12. Unscramble these Hackles words:

|                                 |       |
|---------------------------------|-------|
| <i>Field note</i>               | No. 3 |
| <b>LETL PSAFU KCEHC SEKCLAH</b> |       |

**J29: Count the Flags.** *Bands 3-12.* Read this message and count the **SPOT** flags (S, P, O, T) in it:

|                                                                                        |       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| <i>Field note</i>                                                                      | No. 4 |
| <b>"Hi! You won!!! Only 3 minutes left! Click here and log in. Don't tell anyone!"</b> |       |

**J30: What Am I?** *Bands 3-12.* I unlock your accounts, but I'm not a key. I am only for you and your trusted grown-up. If someone asks for me by chat, your hackles should pop up. What am I?

#### ANSWER KEY (TEACHER ONLY)

| #   | ANSWER                                                                                                                                                                        | TEACHING POINT                                                                                  |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| J24 | <b>THE SECRET WORD IS SILLY</b> (shift back I).                                                                                                                               | A good passphrase is silly.                                                                     |
| J25 | <b>6</b> ( $3 \times 2 \times 1$ ): banana-rocket-trumpet, banana-trumpet-rocket, rocket-banana-trumpet, rocket-trumpet-banana, trumpet-banana-rocket, trumpet-rocket-banana. | Different orders = more combinations. Order matters; words in random order are harder to guess. |
| J26 | <b>A</b> (pixelpals.example). B has a I for an "I". C adds "-free". D hides the real name before the end.                                                                     | Spot lookalikes; the real name is right before the last dot.                                    |
| J27 | <b>Check.</b>                                                                                                                                                                 | The routine in order.                                                                           |
| J28 | <b>TELL, PAUSE, CHECK, HACKLES.</b>                                                                                                                                           | The routine words.                                                                              |
| J29 | <b>4</b> (S: don't tell anyone. P: only 3 minutes left. O: you won. T: click here and log in).                                                                                | SPOT.                                                                                           |
| J30 | <b>A password</b> (or passphrase).                                                                                                                                            | Passwords are secret; share only with a trusted adult.                                          |

#### MORE BRAIN TEASERS (BONUS, FOR QUICK USE)

- 1. Odd one out:** *Pause Palm, Check Eyes, Tell Wave, Pop-up Tap.* (**Pop-up Tap**; it is the one we do **not** do!)
- 2. Mirror code:** Use A=Z, B=Y: **KZFHV.** (**PAUSE**)
- 3. Number code (A=1):** **20 5 12 12.** (**TELL**)
- 4. What goes up when something is odd, but only comes down when you tell someone?** (**Your hackles!**)

5. **True or false?** "If a message says 'don't tell your parents,' it's safe if the sender is nice." (**False.** Secrets plus pressure is a hackles-up.)

#### TRICKS TO MAKE TEASERS EVEN FUNNIER

- **Gifty Voice:** read the teaser in Gifty's game-show voice.
- **Peeper's Pause:** before answering, everyone says "Hmmmmmm!"
- **Pair Tell:** whisper the answer to a partner before saying it out loud.
- **Make-your-own:** students create a teaser that has a **checkable answer** and a **skill** (a safe cipher, a count, a pattern). Share on Friday.

## Fun-fact boosters (optional)

Use these as "Did you know?" (the factual ones are marked [VERIFY]):

- A **passphrase** of four random words is usually easier to remember and harder to guess than a short, complicated password [VERIFY with Lesson 2].
- Scam messages often use a **countdown** because pressure makes people skip the thinking step [VERIFY].
- "Hackles" are the raised hair or neck feathers of an animal that senses danger, like the hair on the back of a dog's neck. A hedgehog's quills standing up is the picture of it. Hedgehogs do not literally have hackles; their quills stand up the way hackles do [VERIFY].
- Honestly, nobody knows what Gifty's gift is. It has never been opened.

## Accessibility variants

| NEED                                 | WHAT TO DO                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Color-vision difference</b>       | Nothing depends on color. Joke cards use black text and a symbol per band.                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Low vision / blind</b>            | Read aloud; large-print cards; describe any picture riddle in words.                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Deaf or hard of hearing</b>       | Print or project each joke; the groan can be a thumbs-down-then-laugh gesture or a hand wave.                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Dyslexia / reading difficulty</b> | The teacher reads; teasers J24 and J28 can be done with letter tiles or a partner; allow oral answers.                                                                                                                     |
| <b>English language learners</b>     | Puns depend on sound and idiom. Explain one pun in plain words, use picture riddles (J7, J8, J15), and let newcomers explain a joke from their own language. Use the teasers (J25, J27, J29) that do not rely on wordplay. |
| <b>Motor / mobility</b>              | Answers can be said, pointed, or tapped; no writing needed.                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Sensory / anxiety</b>             | Whisper Round (tell the joke only to a partner). No one has to tell a joke aloud; the Joke Jar is written and anonymous.                                                                                                   |
| <b>Cultural fit</b>                  | The jokes avoid dollars and national references where possible; swap in local words (for example "neigh" works in any language that has a horse sound) and let students write jokes in their own language.                 |

## Printables checklist (print and cut exactly this)

Art comes from the art team. Reference these files in

[kit/09\\_Art/characters/](#) (do not edit them). **[ART REQUEST: Gifty art is not yet in [characters/](#); ask the art team for [giftly.png](#) for the menu and the Gifty cut-out.]**

| # | PRINT                                                                       | HOW MANY                                                                                                  | CUT / ASSEMBLE               | ART TO USE                                                     |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Joke cards</b> (J1-J30: joke on the front, answer and skill on the back) | 30 cards (22 if you skip the teasers; print the band you teach: K-2 8, 3-5 8, 6-12 7, all-band teasers 7) | Cut 30 cards                 | <a href="#">hackle_silly.png</a> (K-5 backs); icon only (6-12) |
| 2 | <b>Teaser sheets</b> (J24-J30 and the 5 bonus teasers)                      | 1 per child for the teasers you choose                                                                    | None                         | <a href="#">peepeer.png</a>                                    |
| 3 | <b>Cipher strips</b> for J24 (A to Z strip)                                 | 1 per pair                                                                                                | Cut                          | none                                                           |
| 4 | <b>Answer key</b> (teacher only)                                            | 1                                                                                                         | Keep apart from student sets | none                                                           |
| 5 | <b>Joke of the Day poster</b>                                               | 1                                                                                                         | None                         | <a href="#">hackle_silly.png</a>                               |
| 6 | <b>Groan Meter poster</b> (tally groans, never points)                      | 1                                                                                                         | None                         | <a href="#">hackle_sleepy.png</a>                              |
| 7 | <b>Joke Jar</b> (a box or jar) and paper slips                              | 1 jar + 30 slips                                                                                          | Cut slips                    | none                                                           |

| # | PRINT                                         | HOW MANY    | CUT / ASSEMBLE | ART TO USE                         |
|---|-----------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 8 | Riddle Café menu (for Hackles Day Station 10) | 1 per table | Fold           | Gifty [ART REQUEST],<br>peeper.png |

Cut list: 30 joke cards, 30 slips, plus posters.

## Make it a routine

- "Joke of the Day" on the board during morning arrival.
- "Groan Meter" poster: tally groans, not points (no one ever loses).
- "Pause and Punchline": the teacher says "Hackles up!" and pauses for a big breath before the answer.
- Joke Jar Friday: read three submitted jokes.
- Reminder: keep every joke kind.